Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California

June, 2002

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Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, June 12th, 7:00 pm, *Fairwood School*

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa 12 Hunyo, 2002, 7:00 pm sa Fairwood School

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el 12 Junio, 2002 a las 7:00 pm en el Fairwood School

City of Sunnyvale and LVNA Cooperate for Improvements

- Editor

The Sunnyvale Community Development Department and your LVNA have formed a partnership to launch an innovative pilot program for neighborhood improvement. The first step of the program is soliciting residents' input on what improvements are most important to them. The City has inserted a survey in this issue of the Villager. This is a wonderful opportunity for Lakewood to lead the way for other neighborhoods in Sunnyvale, and we'll all benefit from the resulting improvements. Please take a few minutes to fill out and return the survey right away.

City officials will also be present at the June LVNA meeting to discuss the project and answer your questions, so please plan to attend. ■

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A Victory for Wetlands Restoration

- Editor

Many of you know that a large portion of the waterfront of the south San Francisco Bay has been used for commercial salt production in evaporation ponds since the 1850's. Cargill Corporation, the agribusiness company that currently owns the ponds, has agreed to sell 16,500 acres to the government so that they can become a public wildlife refuge for birds, fish, and other species.

Some 8,100 acres in Fremont, Alviso, Sunnyvale, and East Palo Alto, will be added to the federally funded Don Edwards San Francisco Bay National Wildlife Refuge. Another 7,000 acres near Hayward and Union City, and 1,400 acres near the Napa River, will be owned by the State of California. Cargill will continue to operate 11,000 acres of ponds near Newark.

Because all of the ponds will need to be gradually diluted to match the salinity of the Bay and some of the ponds will need to be filled with Bay mud from dredging operations, it will take many decades before wildlife and plants can return.

Since 1850, nearly 80% of San Francisco Bay's wetlands have been lost to diking, filling, and development. These 16,500 acres represent more than 10% of that lost acreage, and their restoration will provide habitat for wildlife, help filter pollution, and improve water quality. ■

Lakewood Resident Receives Community Award of Excellence

- Editor

Mayor Fred Fowler and member of the Sunnyvale City Council announced the winners of the community awards at the annual State of the City event on Saturday, May 25. Nominees for the annual awards are solicited from a broad range of community organizations, businesses, schools and citizens. The awards selection committee was comprised of Sunnyvale citizens and business representative appointed by Mayor Fowler.

The Award of Excellence is a special award, given at the discretion of the Mayor, to recognize people or organizations that have made an extraordinary and unique contribution to this community. This year the recipient was Elena Anderson, longtime resident and vice president of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association.



Elena has set an example of personal commitment to the community for many years. For the sake of her neighbors, she has done everything from organizing free tennis lessons for kids to cooking hamburgers at the neighborhood picnic, from leading a force of volunteers who hand deliver 1,700 newsletters each month to helping organize the city's only Holiday Parade. She is a tireless advocate for youth and serves as the hub of an informal support network that identifies and fills youth needs wherever it can.

"Elena personifies the very best that Sunnyvale has to offer. She sets an example for all of us to show with deeds rather than words our own commitment to this community. I am very happy to recognize her many achievements with the Mayor's Award of Excellence", said Mayor Fowler. ■



New Trail and Bridge for Calabazas Creek

- Editor

In April, the City of Sunnyvale recommended approval of funding for the Calabazas Creek Trail Project. The project will provide for the construction of a missing link to the City's bicycle route network. It consists of a connection to the Hetch-Hetchy path on the Fairwood side of Lakewood Village, a crossing of Calabazas Creek with a new trail bridge, and extension of the trail northerly along the creek levy to the Highway 237 vicinity, ultimately connecting it with Baylands Park. When completed, improvements will include signs, fencing, gates, lights, trail surface, and a new bridge across the Santa Clara Valley Water District floodway. ■



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- Editor

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President's Column

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

This has been a busy and productive month in the LVNA. Several major items are in the works:

Traffic

For several years we have been plagued by traffic from the movie complex cutting through the neighborhood. Santa Clara could care less if their development impacted Lakewood. Sunnyvale did a traffic study recently and indeed found that we are impacted by the development. City staff prepared a report and a recommendation to alleviate the traffic problem. At May's city council meeting several alternatives to help with traffic were put to a vote. The Wildwood traffic light at Lawrence Expressway alternative passed the City Council overwhelmingly. Manny Valero and Tim Risch cast the opposing votes. Tim had fiscal concerns that were valid and real; Manny wanted to give the traffic diversion gate alternative a try, which was also a valid choice. All in all the council was clear in understanding that we have a problem with the traffic from the movie complex invading the neighborhood and creating an unsafe condition. Lakewood residents were out in force at the council meeting, several residents were able to speak to the council about the traffic problems and why they wanted the traffic signal alternative. Mayor Fred Fowler, a Lakewood resident, used his vast fiscal knowledge to find the money for the traffic signal and he used his communication skills to bring real meaning to the debate. Good job, Fred! The City staff's report stated that the diversion gate was the best option to control the traffic. This was clearly not what the council felt. I seemed to see city staff frown when this alternative passed. Oh well, that's politics!

Neighborhood Improvement Pilot Program

Lakewood is being surveyed this month to find out what code enforcement issues are important to residents. A pilot program will be developed out of these responses. If you want the pilot program used on your block be sure to note that on the survey. The results of this survey are important to our neighborhood, so send in the city provided stamped response as soon as possible. This will be a neighborhood-friendly program; it will bring up the quality ▶ of life that is so important to Lakewood. Don't wait, send in the survey now!

Dumpster Weekend

The dumpsters are coming to Lakewood on July 20th and 21st. This is a wonderful event that is an annual happening in Lakewood. If this is your first Dumpster weekend, let me explain. The city puts huge trash dumpsters at several locations around Lakewood for residents to get rid of the items that are no longer useful, broken or just plan junk, and it's free of charge. It is a chance to make your property look better by trimming the overgrown shrubs that have been growing out of control. Get rid of the old bricks and concrete that you have been piling in the back yard. Old appliances that you have been meaning to get fixed but realistically never will, get rid of them now. If you have neighbors that can use a good yard cleanup, let them know that this is the time to do it. If some of our neighbors are not physically able to do the cleaning, give them a hand and you will be rewarded with a feeling that you are helping someone that needs your help. ■



Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

Your LVNA is in need of a few good folks to help get the message out. It takes only a few minutes a month, gets you out of the house into the fresh air, and gives you an opportunity to meet some of your neighbors. If you can devote some time as a Newsletter Walker, please call Elena at 745-6028. It's a great way to make a contribution to the Neighborhood! ■

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From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

As always, I'm looking for new sources of articles for the Villager. If you have any urge to write an article, please do! Or, if you have any suggestions for articles to be written by others, send them to me as well.

To contact the Editor of the Villager…

Send your articles, comments, and corrections by email to lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com (note that this is a new email address), by FAX to (408) 738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■

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LVNA Meeting

- Editor

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend this monthly meeting. You will meet some of your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions, and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

This month's meeting will feature a presentation and discussion with the City's Community Development Department about the Neighborhood Improvement pilot program. Please read, fill out, and return the survey that is included in this issue of the Villager, and attend the meeting with your questions and comments.

The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, June 12th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: Fairwood School ■

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- Editor

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From the Police Blotter: Lakewood Village and nearby areas

- Courtesy of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety and Craig Crawford



5/21 somewhere in Sunnyvale - **Bank robbery with a handgun** – A male entered the Bank of the West, vaulted the counter, and took cash from the teller trays – leaving the same way he came in. The suspect brandished a semi-automatic handgun at the tellers to gain their help in getting the cash from their drawers.

5/15 Palmas - **Illegal use of tear gas** – Two unidentified white male adults discharged a tear gas type substance (pepper spray) at three female victims after an attempt to enter the victim's residence. All three victims were later sprayed with pepper spray following an argument that became physical.

5/16 somewhere in Sunnyvale - **Petty Theft** – A white female and a Hispanic male went into the Round Table pizza. While employee was busy the Hispanic male took the monies in the tip jar without permission.

5/12 Lakewood - **Petty theft auto** - Suspect entered victims vehicle through a door and removed black leather organizer. The suspect fled with the victim's property in an unknown direction.

5/12 somewhere in Sunnyvale - **Damage** –Suspect drove his vehicle around three "road closed" signs and around a series of traffic cones in order to get to his residence. While maneuvering his vehicle through fresh slurry seal, the vehicle tracked wet slurry seal onto the city sidewalk and onto the suspect's private drive way. The driver was issued a citation.

5/22 somewhere in Sunnyvale – **Possession of controlled substance** - Officer initiated a vehicle stop on a white Mustang. The driver reached towards the passenger area of car and then threw a small plastic baggie containing an off-white powder out the passenger window. The powder tested positive for amphetamine. The driver also displayed drug use symptoms.

President's note: as I was looking for Lakewood crime I noticed many drug possession crimes, and all of them were amphetamine drugs. This is disturbing, to say the least; people under the influence of those drugs are unpredictable and dangerous. I also noted the there were several transients who were arrested for various crimes, mostly drunkenness and drugs.

Editor's note: As always, if you see suspicious activity or are aware of any crime, no matter how minor it may seem, please report it to Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety. For emergencies, call 911; for non-emergencies, call 730-7100. ■

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This Month in Lakewood History…

- Brian Smithson

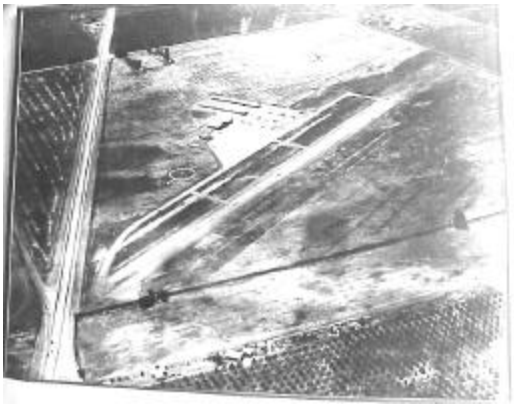
43 years ago: In 1959, Lakewood Methodist Church opens on Sandia Avenue.

41 years ago: In 1961, Our Lady of Peace church parish was established. The actual church opened in October, 1961.

39 years ago: In 1963, the Holiday Inn (now Ramada) opened on Wildwood Avenue.

Did you know…

…before Lakewood Village was developed, there was a small airport on this location? Here's a photo:



Share your history!

Are you a long-time resident of Lakewood Village? Do you have old photographs, real estate brochures, newspaper clippings, or old LVRA/LVNA newsletters sitting in a box in your garage? I'm interested in putting together a year-by-year history of Lakewood Village, and your historical materials would be very helpful. I'd be happy to pick up items, copy them, and return the originals. Call me at 738-5939 or email lvna_editor@magicaldesk.com. ■

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Hetch-Hetchy Greenbelt to be Renamed and Dedicated

- Editor

The City of Sunnyvale will be dedicating and naming the Hetch-Hetchy Greenbelt with a ribbon cutting ceremony on Monday, June 10 from 12 – 12:30 PM at the intersection of Meadowlake Dr. and the Greenbelt, across the street from Lakewood Elementary School in Sunnyvale. The section of the Hetch-Hetchy right-of-way in Sunnyvale will be named the "John W. Christian Greenbelt", after a former City of Sunnyvale Parks and Recreation Director who was instrumental in the vision and implementation of changing the Hetch-Hetchy easement from a bare area to a greenbelt with landscaping and amenities. Mr. Christian enthusiastically promoted the greenbelt concept during his tenure with the City from 1988 until his death in 1996.

The Hetch-Hetchy right-of-way in Sunnyvale is a fairly linear piece of land that is 80 feet wide and 2.7 miles long that extends east to west across the city. The land is owned by the City of San Francisco and is leased and maintained by the City of Sunnyvale. It serves as a pedestrian and bicycle greenbelt that links Fairwood Park with Orchard Gardens Park.

"The Greenbelt in Sunnyvale is an excellent example of two agencies, Sunnyvale and the San Francisco Public Utilities Commission, working together to provide the public with a recreational facility that combines form and function," said Scott Morton, Sunnyvale Parks Supervisor. ▶

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▶ The City has been working on this project since late 1996 when the City Council authorized staff to pursue an open space agreement with the San Francisco Public Utilities Commission for development and maintenance of the 2.7 mile trail segment within Sunnyvale city limits.

The ribbon cutting ceremony will be followed by a reception with light refreshments. ■

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Street Light Repairs		730-7510
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Lakewood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Lakewood/index.html
Fairwood School	http://www.sesd.org/Schools/Fairwood/index.html
Coming soon: an LVNA Web Site!	Look for details in an upcoming edition of the Villager

Calendar of Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Greenbelt Dedication Ceremony	Meadowlake Drive/Greenbelt	6/10/02, 12-12:30 pm
Bookmobile	Fairwood School	6/11/02, 2:15-3pm
LVNA General Meeting	Fairwood School	6/12/02, 7-8 pm
Bookmobile	Lakewood School	6/13/02, 2-3pm
Dumpster Weekend	various Lakewood locations	7/20/02-7/21/02

High Speed Internet Access in Lakewood Village

- Brian Smithson

My experience of trying to get high speed Internet access in our neighborhood was that it is difficult or impossible. I was eventually able to get a microwave-based wireless service, but that service is no longer available to new subscribers.

I would like to hear from others who have tried to get DSL, cable modem, or other high-speed Internet services in our area. If you tried – whether or not you were successful – please take a moment to send me a quick email about it. If there is as much of a problem as I suspect, then I plan to survey the neighborhood to gather some statistics about Internet access demand and perhaps convince the local telephone, cable, and wireless companies to properly provide services to Lakewood Village.

Send your email to internet_survey@grot.com and let me know what you tried (DSL, cable, or other), which companies you contacted, and whether or not you were successful. ■



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